

Portable video

Most PMPs play video in a format called Streaming Mobile Video with the file extension .smv

AVCHD camcorder by Sony

Sony announces an AVCHD camcorder to be launched in 3rd quarter of 2010. Built around the new E-mount system, it will be compatible with existing alpha lenses

Agent 001

Q I am looking for a graphics card for my desktop. I play high end games but I don't need eye-candy features turned on. My desktop configuration is Pentium dual core 2.8 GHz, 1 GB Ram, 256 MB onboard ATi video solution, 500 GB HDD. My budget is Rs. 5,000.

Anand

A You haven't mentioned which motherboard you are on, but I assume you have a PCI Express slot. In case you don't, I recommend upgrading your PC itself, because an older AGP card will cost you a bomb without giving any performance benefits. But for the most suitable graphic card for Rs. 5,000, I recommend looking at AMDs ATi Radeon HD 5670 GPU. Cards based on this GPU should be priced around the 5,000-rupee mark, though prices may be on the higher side of 5K. If you want something a little cheaper, look at the NVIDIA GeForce 9600GT. Cards based on this GPU should cost you no more than Rs. 5,000.

Q I have been using Creative EP 630 for two years now and was satisfied by their quality. Now I am looking for an upgrade and change of earphones. My budget is preferably under 1,000 Rs. My requirements are in-ear earplug, 1.2 m cord (shorter cords are irritating), normal Y cord and no punchy bass. I have short-listed two earphones namely Creative EP 830 and Sony MDR EX33LP. Are either of them any better than EP630? Please recommend any other brands that you find suited to my needs.

Mihir Pendse

A The Creative EP630 is actually the best value that can be had for Rs. 1,000. The EP830 is slightly costlier, depending on where you shop for it, as online stores will offer it for Rs. 1,000, but local shops will charge as much as Rs. 1,600. At some places, the EP630 sells for more than Rs. 1,000. If you want something dramatically better, you need to up your budget to at least Rs. 3,000. Else, any difference will not be noticeable. The EP830 is better built than the EP630, but there is hardly any difference in performance.

Q I am thinking of buying a PC for multi-media purposes only here is the configuration and the prices from <http://www.linx-india.com> and its not meant for gaming.

- Gigabyte GA-EG41MF-US2H Rs. 3,885
- Intel Core 2 Duo E7500 Rs. 5,408
- Thermaltake Strike MX Rs. 3,675
- WDC 640 GB SATA 3.5" Rs. 2,657
- Sapphire Radeon HD 4550
- Coolermaster eXtreme Power Plus 500W Rs. 2,893
- Coolermaster Hyper TX3 Rs. 1,173
- RAM 4GB Corsair Rs. 4,000
- Sennheiser HD201 Rs. 1,335
- BenQ G2220HD Rs. 9,200
- Logitech Klassik Keyboard K100 Rs. 350

Abhishek Joshi

A The configuration is good for multi-media, but the price of the CPU seems to be a little high. Since you are not gaming, the graphics card is a good choice. I do not think there is a need to purchase a CPU cooler, unless you are planning to overclock, because the E7500 is a very cool CPU. Make sure to double-check the terms of delivery, because you are getting a rather big package shipped and preferably it should be insured.

Q Please suggest me a good CPU + motherboard + RAM combo. My preferred configuration is:

Intel Core 2 Duo E7500 / E8400 / Q8400 (Rs. 8,000/-). Motherboard preferred brands - Gigabyte, ASUS (Rs. 8,000/-) with a good onboard graphic and sound card. I also need a cabinet with 450W good SMPS.

Vinod Agarwal

A I would go with a Core 2 Quad Q8400 along with a Gigabyte G41 motherboard. 2 GB DDR2 800 MHz RAM would cost you Rs. 2,500, I would recommend going for 4 GB. Look at Kingston. Go with a CM Elite 330 chassis and a VIP 450 watt power supply.

Q My 5-year old PC with following configuration:

- Processor: Intel P4 CPU 2.4GHz
- motherboard: ASUS P4GE-MX
- RAM: 768 MB DDR
- SMPS: 250W

- HDD: 80GB IDE HDDs
- Graphics card: NVIDIA FX5500 256MB AGP
- Samsung DVD writer

I need such PC that will be used in software development. Dot net latest (3.5), Database server like MSSQL 2005, Oracle.

Amit Naik

A I would recommend an AMD Athlon II X2 240 (Rs. 2,900) and a Gigabyte MA78GM-US2H (Rs. 4,200). Buy 4 GB of DDR2 800 Kingston RAM, this will cost you around Rs. 5,100. Make sure you get two sticks of 2 GB each. The motherboard I have suggested has a 780G Northbridge, that features a Radeon HD 3200 integrated graphics solution - much better than the GeForce FX5500. I recommend a 400-watt power supply from VIP for the same.

Q Please help me to choose between budget touch phones like LG Cookie Pep, Samsung Corby & Nokia 5233.

Arindam Bagchi

A I have assumed you are talking about the Samsung Corby Pro (B5310). I recommend the Corby Pro, simply because it also has a decent hardware QWERTY keypad, whereas the other phones mentioned here do not. We tested this phone and found it to be a decent buy, if you must have a budget touchscreen phone.

Q I am planning to buy a new digital camera for shooting documentaries for my school day. Can you recommend me a digital camera with high picture and video clarity within the range of Rs. 15,000 to Rs. 25,000.

P. Sai Sandeep

A That is a good budget range and there are many options available. You haven't mentioned if you want a compact point-n-shoot, or a pseudo dSLR. I am going to give you both options. For a point-n-shoot, look at Panasonic's Lumix DMC TZ7 - this is a really compact, yet powerful option with a 12x optical zoom and a 12.7-megapixel sensor. Expect to pay around Rs. 18,000 for this camera, and Panasonic also provides a nice three year warranty. If you want a pseudo-dSLR look at Panasonic's FZ35 - priced at Rs. 21,000. **■**